

Verb Tenses

(Tiempos verbales)

Verb Tenses			
Base form	Infinitive (to + base)	Gerund (-ing)	Participle (-ed/3ª columna irregulares)
study	to study	studying	studied
Verb Tenses			
	Past	Present	Future
Simple (1 palabra)	I studied -ed / 2ª columna irregulares	I study forma base	I will study will + forma base I'm going to study be going to + forma base
Continuous (be + -ing)	I was studying was/were + -ing	I am studying am/is/are + -ing	I will be studying will be + -ing
Perfect Simple (have/has + participio)	I had studied had + participio	I have studied have/has + participio	I will have studied will have + participio
Perfect Continuous (have/has been + -ing)	I had been studying had been + -ing	I have been studying have/has been + - ing	I will have been studying will have been + participio

P R E S E N T T E N S E S

PRESENT SIMPLE

base form (-s 3rd person singular)
Auxiliary: do/does

always, never, usually, often, rarely, etc.
once every three months, twice a week, etc.

- 1 Habitual, regular actions in the present.

I wash my hair every day. She lives in Fuente Obejuna. My father works as a salesman.

- 2 Present states. Things that are always or generally true.

I don't like cheese. I have two brothers. My older brother is very tall. Water boils at 100 degrees. I love pizza.

- 3 To talk about the future in first conditional and future time clauses (*when, as soon as, after, before, once, while*).

I'll call you as soon as I arrive. Send us a postcard while you are there. I'll meet my friends after I finish my homework.

- 4 Future timetabled/scheduled events (trains, classes, etc.)

School starts at 8.30 a.m. What time does the concert start tonight? I have an appointment with the doctor on Monday.

PRESENT CONTINUOUS

am/is/are + verb (-ing)

now, these days, this week, at present, etc.
Look! Listen!

- 1 Actions in progress; things that are happening now or around now.

I'm watching a new series now. Listen! The neighbours are having an argument. What are you doing?

- 2 Future arrangements (with a future time expression)

I'm seeing the dentist at 6. We are going on a trip next month. I'm flying to Madrid tomorrow morning.



Non-action verbs (stative verbs) are never in continuous forms.

- Verbs of the senses (*hear, see, smell, etc.*)
- Verbs of opinion (*believe, consider, like, love, hate, prefer, think, etc.*)
- Verbs of possession (*have, own, belong, etc.*)
- Other common stative verbs (*agree, be, depend, need, mean, remember, realise, recognise, seem, want, etc.*)

P R E S E N T T E N S E S

PRESENT PERFECT SIMPLE

have/has + past participle

ever, never, before, once, twice, three times, etc.
just, already, yet, for, since, how long, recently, lately, etc.
superlative

- 1 Experiences. We don't say when the action happened.

Have you ever been to Ireland? This is the best film I've ever seen. I've read this book twice. I've never been here before.

- 2 Recent past events that are relevant now. We don't say when the action happened.

I've passed the exam! She's just called. Have you finished yet? We've already tidied up the room.

- 3 Actions or states that started in the past and have not finished.

How long have you been married? We've known each other since we were children. I've been very busy lately. I've lived in this house for over 20 years.

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

have/has + been + verb (-ing)

for, since, how long, recently, lately, every
week/day/etc., all morning/day/etc.

- 1 With action verbs to talk about situations that started in the past and have not finished or have just finished. There is often a present result from doing these actions.

I've been working on the computer and now I have a terrible headache. Your face is very red, have you been running?

- 2 Use *for, since, how long, lately, all day/week/month/etc.* to ask or say how long a situation has been happening.

I haven't been feeling well lately. He's been annoying us all evening. She's been studying very hard for weeks. How long have you been playing tennis?

- 3 Repeated actions from the past till now.

She's been calling you for days.

P A S T T E N S E S

PAST SIMPLE

verb (-ed / irregular verbs)
Auxiliary: did

yesterday, last week, last year, in 2010,
two hours ago, three years ago

- 1 Habitual actions in the past, and past states.

Sarah always arrived on time. She travelled very often. She didn't like coffee. She was very tall. They had two children. We lived in the country.

- 2 Past finished actions.

We arrived last Friday. I missed the train. We moved to Seville last year. When did you get married?

- 3 Past events in chronological order (in narratives).

I opened the door, walked into the room and saw him.

- 4 Situations that started and finished in the past (duration).

I played football for twenty years. How long did you live in Brussels? I loved him since the day I met him.

PAST CONTINUOUS

was/were + verb (-ing)

while, when, yesterday at three o'clock

- 1 Actions in progress at a certain time in the past, or when another shorter action in past simple happened.

At 10 p.m. I was sleeping like a baby. When she arrived, we were cooking dinner. Where were you going when I saw you?

- 2 In narratives, we can use the past continuous to set the scene at the beginning of a story.

It was getting dark, and I was walking fast to the pub when I suddenly ran into her.

P A S T T E N S E S

PAST PERFECT SIMPLE

had + past participle

when, by the time, already, just, never, ever, for, since, etc.

- 1 Events that happened earlier in the past.

When Anne arrived at the party, it had already finished. By the time the police arrived, he had already left.

- 2 We use the Past Perfect Simple in the same way as the Present Perfect Simple (but speaking from the past about events or situations happening earlier in the past).

When I met them, they had been married for 10 years. How long had you known her when she died? In 1995, I had never taken a plane. She had just arrived when she noticed that something was missing. When he called, we had not finished yet.

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

had + been + verb (-ing)

by the time, when, how long, for, since, lately, all day, etc.

- 1 With action verbs to talk about longer continuous actions that had started earlier in the past.

How long had she been waiting when you saw her? When the bus arrived, we'd been waiting for more than 20 minutes. We had been driving for less than an hour when the car broke down.

- 2 With action verbs to talk about repeated actions from earlier in the past.

I couldn't believe it; she had been writing a letter every day for over a year. I told Jane that I had been calling her for hours, and she just ignored me.

FUTURE TENSES

FUTURE SIMPLE

will + base form

- 1 Predictions about something we think will happen.

I think he'll win the election. He will be a good doctor.

- 2 Instant decisions.

I'll have a hamburger, please.

- 3 Also:

- Promises (*I will*)
- Suggestions (*Shall we?*)
- Offers (*Shall I?/I will*)
- Requests (*Will you?*)

*be going to
am/is/are + going to + base form*

- 1 Predictions about something that we see it will happen (present evidence).

I don't know the answers, I'm going to fail the test. The doctor said I'm going to have a baby girl.

- 2 Decisions that you have already taken at the moment of speaking (intentions or plans).

I'm going to stay home today because I have to study.

FUTURE CONTINUOUS

will + be + verb (-ing)

at + time (9 o'clock tomorrow, etc.), this time tomorrow/next week, etc.,
when + clause (you arrive, etc.),
in ... time (in two weeks time, in three years time, etc.)

- 1 Future actions that will be in progress (not finished) at a certain time in the future.

I'll be flying to Rome at this time tomorrow. When you get off the train, I'll be waiting for you at the station.

- 2 Future arrangements (similar to present continuous or *be going to*).

The band will be performing live at the end of the month. We'll be leaving early in the morning.

FUTURE TENSES

FUTURE PERFECT SIMPLE

will + have + past participle

by tomorrow, by 2050, by the time..., by this time..., in three days, in two weeks, in three days' time, etc.

- 1 Actions that will be finished before a certain time in the future.

By 2080, we will have invented flying cars. By the time you arrive, I'll have finished the report. By this time next year, I will have graduated. They will have finished the new motorway in 3 months.

- 2 With non-action verbs, for states that will continue until a certain time in the future, or another action in the future (*for, since, how long*).

By the time I leave, I will have been in England for 6 months. By next Monday, you will have had the book for 3 weeks, and the limit is 2 weeks.

FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS

will + have + been + past participle

by 2030, in two years(' time), in 2026,
for, since, how long

- 1 With action verbs to talk about the duration of a situation in progress at a particular point in the future.

When they get married next year, they will have been going out for over 8 years. By the end of the day, we will have been exploring the cave for 9 hours. In two years, I will have been working here for 30 years.